

Project Management English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: project managers, program managers, PMO staff, scrum masters, delivery leads, operations managers, and cross-functional coordinators

Focus: A project-management English curriculum for scope, schedule, risks, dependencies, stakeholder alignment, status reporting, change control, delivery governance, and difficult timeline conversations.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Project Charter and Scope Definition

Situation

A sponsor asks the team to start before scope is agreed.

Stakeholder pressure: Begin execution and define scope later.

Constraint: Objectives, deliverables, assumptions, exclusions, and decision rights need alignment.

Terms to use

- charter
- scope
- assumption
- exclusion

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A sponsor asks the team to start before scope is agreed.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Begin execution and define scope later.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects scope.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a project charter excerpt.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects scope.

Option	Phrase
A	scope
B	charter
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Begin execution and define scope later.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	We should act now and resolve charter after the result is visible.
C	A project charter excerpt is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify charter and scope against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A sponsor asks the team to start before scope is agreed. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the project charter excerpt with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 2. Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

Situation

A launch date is announced before vendor dates are confirmed.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell teams to compress their tasks.

Constraint: Critical path, dependency owners, buffers, and decision dates are unresolved.

Terms to use

- critical path
- dependency
- milestone
- buffer

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A launch date is announced before vendor dates are confirmed.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell teams to compress their tasks.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects dependency.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a schedule risk update.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects dependency.

Option	Phrase
A	milestone
B	critical path
C	decision owner
D	dependency

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell teams to compress their tasks.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A schedule risk update is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify critical path and dependency against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve critical path after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A launch date is announced before vendor dates are confirmed. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the schedule risk update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Module 3. Risk Register and Issue Escalation

Situation

A risk has become an active blocker.

Stakeholder pressure: Keep it green until the next steering meeting.

Constraint: Severity, probability, impact, mitigation, and owner must be updated.

Terms to use

- risk register
- issue log
- mitigation

- owner

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A risk has become an active blocker.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Keep it green until the next steering meeting.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects issue log.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a risk-to-issue escalation.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects issue log.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	risk register
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Keep it green until the next steering meeting.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify risk register and issue log against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A risk has become an active blocker. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Option	Phrase
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the risk-to-issue escalation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	decision owner

Module 4. Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

Situation

Two executives give conflicting direction to the team.

Stakeholder pressure: Try to satisfy both quietly.

Constraint: Decision rights, tradeoffs, and escalation path need clarification.

Terms to use

- governance
- RACI
- decision rights
- steering committee

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Two executives give conflicting direction to the team.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Try to satisfy both quietly.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects RACI.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a governance decision note.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects RACI.

Option	Phrase
A	governance
B	RACI
C	decision rights
D	steering committee

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Try to satisfy both quietly.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify governance and RACI against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Two executives give conflicting direction to the team. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the governance decision note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 5. Change Requests and Scope Creep

Situation

A business lead asks for additional reporting in the same timeline.

Stakeholder pressure: Add it because the request is small.

Constraint: Impact on scope, timeline, cost, quality, and dependencies must be assessed.

Terms to use

- change request
- scope creep
- impact analysis
- baseline

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A business lead asks for additional reporting in the same timeline.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Add it because the request is small.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects scope creep.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a change request response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects scope creep.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	scope creep
D	change request

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Add it because the request is small.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A change request response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify change request and scope creep against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A business lead asks for additional reporting in the same timeline. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the change request response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

Module 6. Status Reporting and Executive Updates

Situation

The project has many small problems and leaders want a simple color status.

Stakeholder pressure: Mark it yellow without details.

Constraint: Executives need trend, risks, decisions, and owner accountability.

Terms to use

- status report
- RAG status
- trend

- decision ask

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The project has many small problems and leaders want a simple color status.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Mark it yellow without details.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects RAG status.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a executive status update.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects RAG status.

Option	Phrase
A	RAG status
B	trend
C	decision ask
D	status report

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Mark it yellow without details.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify status report and RAG status against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve status report after the result is visible.
D	A executive status update is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - The project has many small problems and leaders want a simple color status. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the executive status update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Option	Phrase
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Module 7. Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

Situation

A vendor misses a deliverable and proposes a vague recovery plan.

Stakeholder pressure: Accept the revised date.

Constraint: Deliverables, acceptance criteria, resourcing, and escalation terms need definition.

Terms to use

- deliverable
- acceptance criteria
- SLA
- escalation

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A vendor misses a deliverable and proposes a vague recovery plan.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Accept the revised date.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects acceptance criteria.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a vendor recovery plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects acceptance criteria.

Option	Phrase
A	acceptance criteria
B	SLA
C	deliverable
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Accept the revised date.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	evidence threshold
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify deliverable and acceptance criteria against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	A vendor recovery plan is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A vendor misses a deliverable and proposes a vague recovery plan. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the vendor recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 8. Post-Implementation Review

Situation

A project launches late and the sponsor wants a quick lessons-learned meeting.

Stakeholder pressure: Focus only on what went well.

Constraint: Root causes, decisions, handoffs, and preventive actions need honest review.

Terms to use

- postmortem
- lesson learned
- root cause
- action item

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A project launches late and the sponsor wants a quick lessons-learned meeting.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Focus only on what went well.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects lesson learned.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a post-implementation review.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects lesson learned.

Option	Phrase
A	action item
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	postmortem

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Focus only on what went well.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	evidence threshold
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify postmortem and lesson learned against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	A post-implementation review is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A project launches late and the sponsor wants a quick lessons-learned meeting. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the post-implementation review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	operating constraint

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Project Charter and Scope Definition - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. charter	'charter' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Project Charter and Scope Definition - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify charter and scope against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Project Charter and Scope Definition - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the project charter excerpt with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. critical path	'critical path' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify critical path and dependency against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the schedule risk update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Risk Register and Issue Escalation - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. risk register	'risk register' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Risk Register and Issue Escalation - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify risk register and issue log against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Risk Register and Issue Escalation - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the risk-to-issue escalation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. governance	'governance' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify governance and RACI against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the governance decision note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Change Requests and Scope Creep - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. change request	'change request' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Change Requests and Scope Creep - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify change request and scope creep against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Change Requests and Scope Creep - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the change request response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Status Reporting and Executive Updates - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. status report	'status report' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Status Reporting and Executive Updates - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify status report and RAG status against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Status Reporting and Executive Updates - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the executive status update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. deliverable	'deliverable' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify deliverable and acceptance criteria against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the vendor recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Post-Implementation Review - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. postmortem	'postmortem' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Post-Implementation Review - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify postmortem and lesson learned against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Post-Implementation Review - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the post-implementation review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.